



Aki Fukai

Principal Product Designer

Enterprise SaaS &
Regulated Platforms

- 🇨🇭 Swiss Citizen
- 📍 Hamburg, Germany (Hybrid/Remote)
- 📅 B2B Retainer Contracts (3–18+ months)
- ➡ Available now · 3–5 days/week

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Design & UI Architecture

- Figma (*variables/tokens, auto layout, Make*)
- Scalable, modular design systems
- Design-to-code (*Storybook, tokens, MCP*)
- Multi-device systems (*web, mobile, POS*)
- WCAG 2.2 / WCAG 3.0 (*Draft*)

Ideation & Collaboration

- Notion · Miro · FigJam · Excalidraw
- JIRA · Asana · Linear
- Slack · kChat

Design Engineering

- Git Workflows (*GitHub / GitLab*)
- HTML5 · CSS3 · CSS transitions
- Micro-interactions & motion specs
- VS Code/CLI · Claude Code · MCP Server

Methods & Frameworks

- Shape Up (*Product Strategy*)
- Jobs-to-be-Done (*JTBD*)
- Event storming & service design
- Lean UX & rapid prototyping
- Audit-to-implementation cycles

Languages

German: Native
English: C1 (*Advanced proficiency*)
French: B1 (*Intermediate*)

Education

HAW Hamburg, Communication design

Principal Product Designer with 20+ years in digital product and service design — the last 13+ focused on high-complexity B2B SaaS, regulated platforms, and AI-informed workflows. Proven track record turning compliance requirements, multi-role architectures, and high-volume data into scalable, audit-proof platforms — from product discovery through design system delivery.

Project Experience 2026–2015

Selected Recent Freelance Engagements, 2024 to Now

Jul 2024 – Present · Freelance (B2B contracts) · Remote/On site
PropTech · Healthcare/EAP · Future of Work · Energy/IoT

Engaged as Principal Product Designer and UX and DS Architect across rapid discovery, branding, and scalable UI architecture.

- **PropTech Startup** (Stealth): Brand identity and design system from zero 2025–2026
- **Healthcare SaaS** (NDA): Product discovery and UX roadmap for platform expansion 2025
- **Ringer** (HR Tech SaaS/ATOSS): UX architecture, rebranding, and platform relaunch 2025
- **1komma5°** (Clean Energy): Design system consulting and fluid-/responsive component set · 2024

Design Director, **whatever.works** (JobRad Venture)

May 2023 – Jun 2024 · Freelance (B2B contract) · Remote
HR Tech · Multi-tenant SaaS · Future of Work

Led B2B HR-Tech product design from initial discovery to a multi-tenant enterprise platform.

- **Velocity**: Delivered a market-ready MVP in 70 days, scaling to 30+ corporate clients
- **Compliant UX Architecture**: Streamlined user flows for 150+ countries
- **Team Building**: Hired a designer and mentored her toward independent ownership
- **Technical Integration**: Localisation (Lokalise), RBAC, SSO, account customisations, HRIS API integr.
- **Design System**: Scalable UI architecture for seamless engineering handoff and consistent UX
- **Recognition**: "Best HR Startup 2023" — product design and ease of use as key differentiator

Reference: Uwe Michaelis, Founder & Managing Director @ WHATEVER.WORKS

Principal Product Designer, **PlasticPlan** (Henkel Venture)

Feb – Jul 2022 · Freelance (B2B contract) · Remote
AI-powered RegTech · Circular Economy

Designed the UX for automated plastic tax compliance across high-volume data and AI-driven classification workflows.

- **Cost Efficiency**: UX/UI enabled up to 80% AI-driven reduction in plastic tax reporting costs
- **Scale**: 236M+ data points processed, 800K+ packaging components, 160K+ products classified
- **Complexity**: Simplified high-compliance, multi-role workflows into audit-proof dashboards
- **AI-UX Integration**: Translated AI data checks into actionable UI with low cognitive load
- **Design System**: Scalable, bilingual (DE/EN) component-driven UI architecture

Reference: Dr. Nora Mundschenk, Corporate Director Global Tax @ Henkel

Senior Product Designer, **enfore AG**

Jun 2018 – May 2020 · Hamburg (hybrid) · *Initially Freelance (B2B contract), later permanent*
Commerce OS · Retail FinTech · POS · ERP

Architected a large-scale ERP/POS ecosystem distributed by major European telco partners.

- **Operational Workflows**: Process maps and interfaces for time-critical retail operations — barcode scanning, inventory management, fast role switches, multi-location data sync
- **Integrated On/Offline Commerce**: End-to-end commerce architecture (POS, mobile, web)
- **SME-Focused UX**: Simplified complex ERP processes for non-technical business users
- **KPI Dashboards**: Modular KPI dashboard system for real-time monitoring across locations
- **Order Fulfilment**: Pick-up, delivery, inventory tracking, and delivery coordination flows
- **Design System**: Scaled architecture for complex multi-device workflows across multiple verticals

Reference: Christophe Stoll, Head of Design @ Enfore's internal design studio

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Co-Founder & Founding Designer, Hello Meet — Group Scheduling

Jan 2018 – Mar 2024 · Hamburg und remote · *Initially part-time, full-time Jun 2020 – Dec 2021*
Social Group Scheduling Product (mobile app)

Led the complete product design from early concepts and business model design through multiple product iterations. Development paused.

- **Product Discovery:** JTBD-based UX strategy with hypothesis-driven validation cycles
- **Product Development:** End-to-end continuous user-centred feature delivery
- **Product Strategy:** Developed and successfully tested a local-first C2B business model
- **Cross-Platform Systems:** Designed and maintained UI & design systems across iOS, Android, Web

Reference: Robert Wunsch, Founder & CPTO @ Hello Meet

Founding Senior Interaction Designer, collectAI (Part of Otto Group)

Feb 2016 – Feb 2018 · Hamburg (on-site) · *Initially Freelance (B2B contract), later permanent*
FinTech · AI-Receiveables · White-label SaaS

Led UX and UI as founding product designer for a customer-centric receivables platform. Designed multi-party, white-label self-service payment and debt-resolution flows and the AI-driven B2B SaaS management platform.

- **Growth:** Crafted the product design that scaled receivables management to €25M in 18 months
- **White-Label Concept and CSS Architecture:** Highly customisable B2C payment flows
- **Payment Journey Optimisation:** Self-service flows reducing customer service dependencies
- **AI-driven personalised UX:** Configurable intelligent communication logic and payment plans
- **Regulatory Compliance:** Receivables management workflows within strict financial and GDPR rules

Reference: Michael Backes, Co-Founder & CTO @ collectAI

Lead Interaction Designer, SBB Swiss Federal Railways (IVEG)

Nov 2015 – Sep 2016 · Freelance (B2B contract) · Bern, Switzerland 🇨🇭 (on-site > hybrid)
National Infrastructure · Mobility · GIS

Digitising high-stakes rail infrastructure maintenance with precision GIS mapping tools.

- **GIS integration:** Map-based data capture and infrastructure visualisation for offline field-work
- **Field-to-Office:** Complete workflows from field assessment through back-office processing
- **Public Sector:** Navigated complex regulatory and safety requirements through iterative prototyping
- **Design System:** UI component library aligned with SBB corporate identity across iOS and web

Reference: Simon Haesler, Product Owner & GIS Specialist @ SBB CFF FFS

Senior Interaction Designer, frog for Siemens/Unify

Sep 2013 – Jan 2014 · Freelance (B2B contract) · Munich (on-site)
Enterprise Communications · Cloud-Based Team Collaboration SaaS

Designed real-time enterprise collaboration experience for "Project Ansible" (productised as Circuit) with frog Munich. Collaborated directly with product leads and lead software architects from Siemens/Unify. Ensured cross-platform consistency across mobile, web, and tablet for multi-modal team communication.

Reference: Justin Maguire III, Executive Creative Director @ frog Munich

Further Enterprise Engagements 2023-2008

Client / Brand	Sector	Focus	Year(s)
Mercedes-Benz	Automotive	Design System Refactoring My Mercedes	22–23 2009
Babymarkt	E-Commerce	UX Audit	2022
Tagesspiegel	Media	UX Architecture and Relaunch	2022
SAP	Enterprise IT	Fiori Design System & App Finder Architecture	2015
Scout24 Schweiz 🇨🇭	Marketplace	Mobile/Web Search UX Architecture	2015
Telefónica O2	Telco	UX Architecture & Design Lead for O2.de Relaunch	2011
Rossmann	E-Commerce	Multi-portal Relaunch (Shop/Corporate/Career)	2008–2012
CTS Eventim	E-Commerce	UX Architecture for eventim.de Relaunch	2008